

Business

1. 800 barrels of Guinness — roughly 70,000 pints' worth — were recently stolen from a depot in Runcorn, Cheshire. Two lorries were driven into an industrial estate and driven away with the trailers attached. What's the approximate street value of the haul?
 - a. Around £250,000
 - b. Around £500,000
 - c. Around £1 million
2. Volkswagen recently finalised a deal with its unions to cut 100,000 jobs by the end of the decade in what is being described as the biggest shake-up in the automotive industry's history. What is the main force driving VW to such drastic action?
 - a. A global collapse in demand for SUVs
 - b. Rising competition from cheaper Chinese electric vehicles
 - c. New EU safety regulations making older models illegal to sell
3. Uber recently announced it is cutting 3,300 jobs — around 10% of its global workforce — stripping out management layers and merging teams. The company said the savings would not be banked as profit but redirected toward a specific technology. What is it?
 - a. AI-powered surge pricing algorithms
 - b. Robotaxis and autonomous vehicle technology
 - c. A new same-day grocery delivery network
4. ChargePoint, a US electric vehicle charging infrastructure company, recently saw its stock surge by 70% after publishing encouraging results. The company is nearing the end of a three-year turnaround plan. Which of these best describes what that plan has achieved?
 - a. Profitable for the first time, with revenue tripling
 - b. Revenue rising and losses shrinking significantly
 - c. Breakeven achieved by selling off its European operations

Economics

5. The US economy added 162,000 jobs in August, with the unemployment rate (the share of people actively looking for work who cannot find it) holding steady at 4.1%, down from a recent peak of 4.5%. Which sector added the most jobs?
 - a. Manufacturing
 - b. Healthcare and social assistance
 - c. Technology and software

6. The US recently imposed tariffs (taxes on imports) of up to 100% on drones and drone parts, targeting Chinese suppliers — particularly DJI, which dominates the global consumer and commercial drone market. Which of these is NOT a stated risk of this policy?
 - a. US industries that rely on cheap drones, like agriculture and filmmaking, face higher costs
 - b. China retaliates by restricting exports of rare earth minerals used in drone manufacturing
 - c. DJI relocates its headquarters to the US to avoid the tariff entirely
7. Norwegian authorities recently seized a Russian-owned expedition cruise ship in the Arctic archipelago of Svalbard. The vessel was impounded on behalf of Ukraine's state energy company, Naftogaz. Why does Ukraine believe it is owed money by Russia?
 - a. Unpaid gas transit fees from before the 2022 invasion
 - b. An international arbitration award over Russia's annexation of Crimea, worth \$4.2 billion
 - c. Compensation ordered by the UN for damage to Ukrainian pipelines
8. A recent analysis found that CEOs of the 100 largest, lowest-paying US corporations earned how many times more than their average worker last year?
 - a. Around 200 times more
 - b. Around 400 times more
 - c. Around 600 times more

General Knowledge

9. Which country is the world's largest producer of lithium — the metal at the heart of electric vehicle batteries and energy storage?
 - a. Chile
 - b. Australia
 - c. China
10. Which economist, writing in the 18th century, first argued systematically that the wealth of nations comes from labour and markets — not from stockpiling gold — in a book that is often called the founding text of modern economics?
 - a. David Ricardo
 - b. John Maynard Keynes
 - c. Adam Smith

Business

1. 800 barrels of Guinness — roughly 70,000 pints' worth — were recently stolen from a depot in Runcorn, Cheshire. Two lorries were driven into an industrial estate and driven away with the trailers attached. What's the approximate street value of the haul?

a. The haul was worth approximately £250,000. At around £3.50 per pint wholesale, 70,000 pints comes to roughly a quarter of a million pounds — a serious commercial theft, not a pub dare. Police noted, with some dryness, that Guinness's old slogan 'Guinness is good for you' applies only when the drink is bought and paid for.

2. Volkswagen recently finalised a deal with its unions to cut 100,000 jobs by the end of the decade in what is being described as the biggest shake-up in the automotive industry's history. What is the main force driving VW to such drastic action?

b. Chinese electric vehicle competition is the primary driver. Chinese brands — led by BYD — now offer EVs at prices European manufacturers struggle to match, squeezing VW's margins and market share at home and abroad. The 100,000 figure includes cuts agreed in earlier rounds; this latest deal adds 50,000 more by 2030, touching nearly every part of the group.

3. Uber recently announced it is cutting 3,300 jobs — around 10% of its global workforce — stripping out management layers and merging teams. The company said the savings would not be banked as profit but redirected toward a specific technology. What is it?

b. Uber is explicitly funding its robotaxi push with the savings from the layoffs. The company sees autonomous vehicles as the long-term future of ride-hailing — a world where it does not need to pay drivers at all. It is the largest round of Uber job cuts since the pandemic-era redundancies of 2020, when it shed around 6,700 roles.

4. ChargePoint, a US electric vehicle charging infrastructure company, recently saw its stock surge by 70% after publishing encouraging results. The company is nearing the end of a three-year turnaround plan. Which of these best describes what that plan has achieved?

b. ChargePoint has grown revenue and cut its losses substantially — but it is not yet profitable. The CEO described the 70% stock surge as 'the beginning of the momentum', signalling investors are betting on what comes next rather than rewarding current earnings. ChargePoint operates one of the largest EV charging networks in North America, with tens of thousands of charging points.

Economics

5. The US economy added 162,000 jobs in August, with the unemployment rate (the share of people actively looking for work who cannot find it) holding steady at 4.1%, down from a recent peak of 4.5%. Which sector added the most jobs?

b. Healthcare and social assistance has been the most consistent engine of US job growth throughout 2024 and into 2025, driven by an ageing population and post-pandemic catch-up hiring. Manufacturing, by contrast, has been broadly flat. The 162,000 August figure was described as an uptick after a sluggish summer, suggesting the labour market is cooling but not collapsing.

6. The US recently imposed tariffs (taxes on imports) of up to 100% on drones and drone parts, targeting Chinese suppliers — particularly DJI, which dominates the global consumer and commercial drone market. Which of these is NOT a stated risk of this policy?

c. A Chinese company relocating its HQ to the US to dodge US tariffs is not a realistic risk — the tariffs apply to goods made in China regardless of where the parent company is registered. Higher costs for US drone users and Chinese retaliation on materials are both genuine, documented concerns raised by industry groups and trade economists in response to the new measures.

7. Norwegian authorities recently seized a Russian-owned expedition cruise ship in the Arctic archipelago of Svalbard. The vessel was impounded on behalf of Ukraine's state energy company, Naftogaz. Why does Ukraine believe it is owed money by Russia?

b. An international arbitration tribunal ruled that Russia owes Ukraine \$4.2 billion in compensation for seizing Naftogaz's assets when it annexed Crimea in 2014. Since Russia refuses to pay, Ukraine is hunting Russian-owned assets in friendly jurisdictions to collect the debt — a legal strategy known as enforcement of arbitral awards. The Arctic ship is one of the more dramatic examples.

8. A recent analysis found that CEOs of the 100 largest, lowest-paying US corporations earned how many times more than their average worker last year?

c. The ratio was 614:1. Research by the Institute for Policy Studies found that CEO pay at the 100 biggest low-wage employers rose 41.4% between 2019 and 2025. To put that in perspective: if a worker earning the US federal minimum wage worked for 614 years, they would earn what their CEO took home in one. The ratio for large corporations overall is lower, but still around 350:1.

General Knowledge

9. Which country is the world's largest producer of lithium — the metal at the heart of electric vehicle batteries and energy storage?

b. Australia is the world's largest lithium producer by volume, accounting for roughly half of global mine output. Chile holds the largest known reserves and is the top producer of processed lithium compounds, which causes some confusion. China, despite producing little raw lithium, dominates the refining and battery manufacturing stages — giving it enormous leverage over the EV supply chain.

10. Which economist, writing in the 18th century, first argued systematically that the wealth of nations comes from labour and markets — not from stockpiling gold — in a book that is often called the founding text of modern economics?

*c. Adam Smith published *The Wealth of Nations* in 1776 — the same year as the American Declaration of Independence. In it, he argued that free markets and the division of labour, not gold reserves, were the true sources of national prosperity. David Ricardo came later, building on Smith; Keynes was 20th century. Smith's invisible hand metaphor is still quoted in economics textbooks and political speeches today.*